

CRO COLLECTIVE

The CRO Accelerator

The only program built for the role nobody prepared you for.

Prepared by: Warren Zenna, Founder & CEO
warren@thecrocollective.com | thecrocollective.com

THE PROBLEM

The CRO role is the most structurally broken seat in the C-suite.

60–70% of CROs fail within 18–24 months. Not because they lack talent. Because the role itself is architecturally broken.

ROLE AMBIGUITY

~75% of "CRO" titles are actually Super VP of Sales with a bigger title. The role is undefined, and nobody tells you until it's too late.

The #1 structural failure. Nobody owns what "CRO" actually means.

CEO MISALIGNMENT

CEOs hire to transform but evaluate to sell. Comp plans reward new logos when the mandate was retention and expansion.

Hired to build. Evaluated to sell. Fired for not doing both.

ORG UNREADINESS

Three departments operating as political fiefdoms. No shared metrics. No architecture. No operating system.

Responsibility without authority. The CRO inherits the politics.

The result: the shortest-tenured seat in the C-suite. Most CROs spend their first year solving the wrong problems with the wrong people at the wrong speed — and by the time they realize it, the window has closed.

Revenue is not sales. Revenue is how a company grows.

The CRO role exists because companies outgrow their original go-to-market motion and need someone to architect the next one. But the industry treats it like a sales leadership position with a fancier title.

The CRO Accelerator was built for this gap. Not sales training. Not generic executive education. A program designed for the specific architectural, political, and financial challenges that define the CRO role.

What a CRO actually faces in the first year.

A CRO we worked with inherited a \$60M ARR company with \$8.2 million in annual revenue leakage — spread across five handoff points that nobody owned.

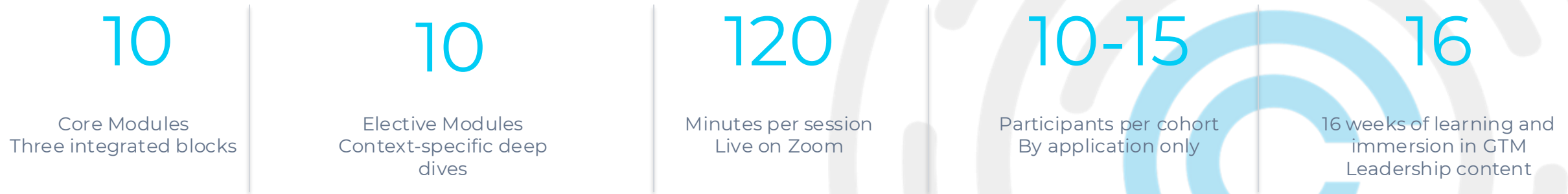
Sales blamed marketing. CS blamed sales. Marketing blamed both. The CEO called it a "culture problem." It was not a culture problem. It was an architecture problem.

That CRO needed to:

- 1. Map the architecture before proposing changes**
- 2. Quantify the leakage in dollars, not opinions**
- 3. Build a coalition before implementing anything**
- 4. Present findings to a board that hired them to "fix sales"**
- 5. Do all of this in 90 days — before the org hardened**

No MBA teaches this. No sales training covers it. No leadership program addresses it. The CRO Accelerator does.

The CRO Accelerator at a Glance



Every session operates at Apply level from minute one. You arrive with your own organizational data and build finished operational artifacts — not notes from a talk.

This is not a lecture series. You do not sit and absorb.

You arrive having completed pre-work with your own organizational data, and from the first minute of every live session, you are building.

Pre-work: every module requires a diagnostic and data collection — completed before the session. Live sessions: 120 minutes on Zoom. Instructor framing is 25% of the time. 75% is you working with your data in structured exercises.

What you walk out with: finished operational artifacts — a stakeholder map, a revenue architecture diagnosis, a financial model, a board presentation outline — built on your organization's actual data.

Prove you can do the work, not just describe it.

Stage 1

Knowledge Exam

Written assessment.
Do you understand the frameworks?

Stage 2

Case Analysis

Written case analysis with grading rubric.
Can you apply the frameworks?

Stage 3

Live Defense

Live presentation and challenge from faculty.
Can you defend under pressure?

Certification

Earned

Not a certificate for showing up. An assessment you earn by demonstrating competence.

This is not a certificate you get for showing up. It is an assessment you earn by demonstrating competence.

6 Optional Modules for the Challenges You Face

Not every CRO faces the same situation. Go deep on what matters most. Also available: Competitive Intelligence, Turnaround CRO, Advanced Forecasting, Land & Expand.

1 PE Operating Cadence

Report to a PE operating partner with a 100-day value creation thesis. Built for the speed and accountability PE demands.

2 Board Simulation

Live roleplay practice before your first real board Q&A. Faculty challenge your assumptions in real time.

3 AI & Revenue

Build AI workflows into the revenue function — not just buy tools. Practical implementation, not vendor demos.

4 First-Time CRO

Never held the title and need to compress the learning curve. Identity diagnostic, readiness assessment, and transition plan.

5 Pricing & Monetization

Restructure pricing without destroying existing revenue. Model the tradeoffs before you pull the lever.

6 M&A Integration

Inheriting or merging revenue teams post-acquisition. Playbook for the first 90 days of integration.

Three Blocks. Ten Modules. One Operating System.

Block A: Foundation · Block B: Revenue Engine · Block C: Leadership & Execution

BLOCK A: CRO FOUNDATION

CM1: CRO Role & CEO
Alignment

CM2: Revenue Architecture

CM3: The First 90 Days

BLOCK B: REVENUE ENGINE

CM4: Financial Modeling

CM5: GTM Strategy

CM6: RevOps & Tech Stack

CM7: Customer Success

BLOCK C: LEADERSHIP & EXECUTION

CM8: Board Communication

CM9: Building & Scaling Teams

CM10: Change Management

Operators Who Have Done the Work

Not academics who study it. Operators who live it.

WARREN ZENNA

Founder & CEO, The CRO Collective. 25 years in revenue leadership.

30+ fractional CRO engagements. 100+ executives coached through the CRO transition.

DEREK SATHER

Co-founder, Winning by Design. 10 years, 600+ companies consulted.

Architect of the Bowtie Revenue Model and the standardized metric taxonomy.

JANELLE PIERINI

Revenue operations and enablement leader.

Bridges strategy and execution. The operational lens every CRO program needs.

GUEST OPERATORS

Rotating practitioners across RevOps, CS, AI, GTM, and metrics.

No one teaches for a living. They operate for a living and teach what they've lived.

WHO THIS IS FOR

CROs, Aspiring CROs, and the CEOs Who Hire Them

You should apply if any of these describe your situation.

01

SITTING CRO

In the seat

< 18 months

Recognizes the role is harder than the title suggests. Needs frameworks, peer support, and honest calibration.

02

VP SALES / MKT / CS

→ **Aspiring CRO** →

10-15 yrs exp

Being told you're "not ready" for the CRO role — and there is nowhere to go to get ready. Until now.

03

CEO

Hiring CROs

2nd or 3rd try

Replaced your CRO twice and suspect the problem is not the person. Send them through this program.

04

PE OPERATING

PARTNER

Portfolio-wide

Portfolio CROs keep failing with 24 months. The pattern is structural, not individual.

THE INVESTMENT

\$6,800 Per Participant. Cohort-Based. By Application.

\$6,800

Investment
per participant

12-16

Participants
per cohort

10+10

Core + Elective
modules

120

Minutes per
live session

June

2026
Next cohort

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- All 10 core modules + access to elective modules
- All pre-work materials, case studies, worksheets, and templates
- 3-stage capstone assessment with live defense
- Ongoing access to the CRO Collective community
- Application + screening conversation required for admission

THE QUESTION

The CRO role will remain the shortest-tenured seat in the C-suite — unless someone changes the operating system.

- 1 Apply for the next cohort — acceptance is based on fit, not first-come-first-served
- 2 Schedule a screening conversation — we'll tell you honestly whether this is right for your situation
- 3 The question is not whether you need this. The question is whether you want to face the CRO role with a framework or without one.

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